Lanka. Bhutan was chosen as the first foreign visit destination of the new Prime Minister. Nepal was the second neighbouring country visited by Prime Minister Modi in August 2014. This was the first Prime Minister–level visit to Nepal after a gap of 17 years. In the case of Sri Lanka, a Prime Ministerial visit occurred after 28 years in March 2015, incidentally after the formation of a new government in Colombo in January that year. In the case of Bangladesh, Prime Minister Modi waited for the ratification of the long-pending Land Boundary Agreement (LBA) by the Indian Parliament. This ratification happened in May, and the visit took place in June 2015. Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj had, however, visited Bangladesh earlier in June 2014 to reassure that country of India's commitment.

During these visits, the Prime Minister sought to reach out to as many people as possible in the host countries. He addressed the national legislatures of all these countries and had discussions with political parties and public leaders across the board. His meetings with the Maoists of Nepal, the ousted President Mahinda Rajapaksa of Sri Lanka, and the opposition BNP leader Khalida Zia in Bangladesh were significant, as all these political leaders were perceived to have reservations about India on one count or another. Rajapaksa had even publicly blamed India for his electoral defeat in January 2015. Modi travelled to Tamil-dominated Jaffna and Talaimannar, as well as the Sinhala religious town of Anuradhapura in Sri Lanka. During his Nepal visit, he had promised to visit the Madhes region of Terai in southern Nepal, which, however, could not mate-rialise. The main objective of these visits was to assure India's respect and support for the sensitivities and developmental aspirations of the neighbouring countries. This invoked a very positive response from the people in all these countries. Nepalese media praised Modi, saying his 30-minute address in the Constituent Assembly in August 2014 had enthused the